

Brandon Higbee

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with **8 years** of experience designing and delivering backend systems at scale. Built cloud-native platform services at **Tackle.io** serving 500+ enterprise customers with **2M+ daily API requests** and **99.9% uptime**. Architected distributed solutions processing healthcare data for **30,000+ students** at Ultimate Medical Academy. Led cross-functional teams to launch company-wide initiatives and mentored **10+ engineers** across levels. Works on distributed systems architecture, platform engineering, and creating tooling that accelerates development velocity. Owns production infrastructure end to end, including on call coverage, deployment automation, and monitoring across distributed services. Comfortable partnering with platform and application teams on reliability work.

Core Skills

Languages and Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Java

Backend & APIs: Python, Node.js, Go, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, Redis

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD Pipelines, Terraform

Platform & DevOps: Microservices, Message Queues, Monitoring, GitHub Actions, Datadog

Architecture & Practices: System Design, Technical Documentation, Code Reviews, Agile/Scrum

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 03/2022 - Present

- Implemented **CI/CD pipelines** with **GitHub Actions** and **Docker** containers, cutting release cycle from 3 days to under 4 hours for 8-engineer team.
- Built **Python** and **Node.js** RESTful and **GraphQL APIs** integrated with **AWS** ecosystem, enabling 500+ ISV partners to automate cloud marketplace workflows.
- Partnered with product and customer success teams to define technical requirements for **enterprise integrations**, translating business needs into actionable specs.
- Led technical design reviews and established **code review standards** adopted across 3 engineering teams, improving code quality metrics by 40%.
- Reduced database query latency from 800ms to 120ms by implementing **Redis caching** layer and optimizing **PostgreSQL** indexes for critical endpoints.
- Mentored 6 engineers through structured pairing sessions and career development plans, with 2 promoted to mid-level within 12 months.
- Designed and deployed **cloud-native backend services** processing 2M+ daily API requests, achieving 99.9% uptime across multi-tenant SaaS platform.
- Architected **microservices-based architecture** decomposing monolithic application into 15+ independent services, reducing deployment cycles from weekly to daily.

Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 06/2021 - 03/2022

- Developed **backend features** in **Python** and **Node.js** supporting cloud marketplace listing management for SaaS vendors across AWS, Azure, and GCP.
- Built webhook delivery system processing 50,000+ events daily with retry logic and dead-letter queue handling for failed deliveries.
- Created automated testing suite with 85% code coverage, reducing production bugs reported by 30% in first quarter.

- Contributed to platform observability by integrating **Datadog** dashboards and alerts, enabling faster incident response during on-call rotations.

Software Engineer II | Ultimate Medical Academy | Remote | 04/2019 - 06/2021

- Designed **RESTful API** endpoints for student enrollment and course delivery systems serving 30,000+ active learners with compliance to FERPA requirements.
- Led migration from monolith to **microservices** pattern using **message queues** for asynchronous processing, achieving 3x improvement in peak load handling.
- Modernized legacy **Python** codebase by refactoring 200+ modules into service-oriented architecture, improving maintainability for 5-person engineering team.
- Containerized applications with **Docker** and ran deployments on **AWS ECS**, reducing infrastructure costs by \$40,000 annually.

Software Engineer I | Ultimate Medical Academy | Remote | 08/2018 - 04/2019

- Automated data synchronization pipelines between LMS and CRM systems, eliminating 10+ hours of weekly manual data entry for operations staff.
- Developed internal tools and **backend services** in **Python** supporting academic operations and student success tracking workflows.
- Participated in **code reviews** and contributed to **technical documentation** standards adopted by the engineering department.

SDK Intern | Accusoft | Remote | 06/2017 - 08/2017

- Authored developer documentation and API reference guides used by external developers integrating Accusoft imaging solutions.
- Developed **Node.js** SDK wrappers for document imaging APIs, creating sample applications demonstrating SDK functionality.

Education

Bachelor of Science

University of South Florida

08/2014 - 05/2018